VOLLEYBALL · GIRLS · GRADES 9 TO 12 · SPORT PLAYBOOK

VOLLEYBALL: THE WHOLE ROAD TO COLLEGE

What to do, when to do it, who pays, and what a coach is and is not allowed to tell you. Built from the 2026-27 NCAA rule text, USA Volleyball's junior calendar, a regional club schedule, and a state association's season dates.

VERSION	RULES CHECKED	LEVELS COVERED
2026-27 · sample player: class of 2029	11 November 2026, against the NCAA rule text, both association calendars and nine club and event pages	D1 · D2 · D3 · NAIA · junior college

> Women's volleyball fields 1,053 NCAA teams, and a girl can be seen at one of them from a free profile page and one email. The club season, not the high school season, is where staffs watch. Both of those facts change what a family should spend money on, and both are free to know.

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This is education. It is not legal advice or school advice. It promises no result, no playing time, no acceptance, and no money. The NCAA Eligibility Center makes the final call on school rules, and each school decides its own aid. Dates marked PROJECTED are worked out from the rule text, not printed by the NCAA yet. Chapter 3 lists them.

1. READ THIS FIRST

Read Chapter 2 before you spend any money. Then put the plan in Chapter 3 on one page and cross items off. The rest is for reference: what the rules allow, what to send, what good video looks like, and what it costs.

THE MAIN IDEA

A family that knows the roster rules, the calendar, and the video standard competes with families spending three times as much. Most of what a $2,000 service sells is phone calls and follow-ups. The rules, the dates, and the right questions are free, and almost nobody writes them down.

WHAT MAKES VOLLEYBALL DIFFERENT FROM BASKETBALL AND FOOTBALL

Three things move the money and the calendar. First, club is the showcase. In the NCAA's own 2025 survey, 94 percent of college volleyball players played both high school and club, 3 percent played high school only, and 2 percent played club only. High school ball in nearly every state is a fall sport, and college coaches are playing their own season in the fall. Second, the number a family needs is a roster number, not a scholarship number. Third, the measurable that matters most is an approach touch, and no college publishes a standard for it. Every jump chart a family buys is one company's target.

A Texas State assistant coach wrote in the AVCA's own blog that her staff faced "over 150 club tournaments between Jan. 1 and Aug. 1 alone." A former Division I head coach, writing on his own site, put it harder: "club volleyball is 99% of our recruiting." He said his only thoughts about his players during the high school season were free touches on the ball, and please do not get hurt.

THREE RULES THAT SURPRISE FAMILIES

- **She may write today; the coach may not answer until 15 June after her sophomore year.** For the class of 2029 that date is 15 June 2027. USA Volleyball states both halves plainly: no rule stops a recruit from emailing, texting, messaging or calling, and Division I and II coaches cannot reply directly until that day.
- **The old 12-scholarship rule is gone at most big schools, and it did not become "unlimited."** Since 1 July 2025, schools in the five defendant conferences and any school that opted in carry an 18-player roster limit instead of a scholarship limit, and aid may be any size on any of those 18. Schools that did not opt in work under the old aid value. There is no printed list of who opted in.
- **There is no National Letter of Intent any more.** The NCAA ended it in October 2024. The paper is now a written offer of athletics aid, signed from the second Wednesday in November of 12th grade. For her, that lands on Wednesday 8 November 2028, worked out from the rule. USA Volleyball's own recruiting page still says "National Letter of Intent." The rule book moved and the guides did not.

WORDS THIS BOOK USES

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
HEAD COUNT	The old Division I rule: 12 scholarships, and each one took one whole spot no matter how small the aid. Women's volleyball used it until 1 July 2025.
EQUIVALENCY	A money ceiling the staff may cut into pieces. Division II is 8.0 and NAIA is 8. A "quarter" is one athlete's worth of money, not one athlete.
ROSTER LIMIT	A cap on people, not money. Division I is 18 for women's volleyball at a school that opted in. A conference may set a lower number, but not below 12.
OPTED-IN SCHOOL	A Division I school that chose the settlement rules. The choice covers every sport at that school and is redone each year for ten years. This book says "opted in" instead of the NCAA's phrase "Participating Institution."
STANDING REACH	How high her hand gets with her feet flat on the floor, shoes on. It is the starting line for every jump number.
APPROACH TOUCH	How high her hitting hand touches after a real approach. Coaches say "touch" or "attack jump." It is not the same as a vertical.
VERTICAL	Touch minus reach: how high she got off the floor. Two players can touch the same height with very different verticals. Ask which number a chart shows.
HITTING PERCENTAGE	(kills minus errors) divided by swings. A middle who only gets easy quick sets can post a big one. A .250 or better is the line one service uses for a good Division I season.
RECEPTION ERROR	A serve she did not handle. It is the number a libero is really judged on, and the NCAA does not rank it nationally. Ask a coach for the count by match.
PERFECT PASS	A pass that reaches the setter's target. Some coaches score 0 to 3, some 0 to 4, so "2.5" means nothing without the scale. A USC coach on the record looked for 62 to 66 percent perfect.
BID	A place at a national qualifier. Some bids come only from a national qualifier, and National, American and Freedom bids can come from her own region's qualifier.
AID AGREEMENT	The written offer that replaced the letter of intent. One school, and the others must stop recruiting her once she signs.
CORE-COURSE GPA	The Grade Point Average the NCAA builds from its own 16 approved subjects, always on a 4.0 scale. Floors: 2.3 for Division I, 2.2 for Division II. It can differ from her school's GPA.
PROJECTED	A date this book worked out from rule text the NCAA has not printed yet for the 2028-29 year. Chapter 3 marks every one.

2. HOW MANY PLAYERS A TEAM CAN TAKE, PART 1: THE RULES

This is the chapter that decides how many schools to write to, when to start, and how much to spend. Read the left column first. The number that used to matter was money. For most big schools it is now people.

LEVEL	WHAT THE RULE SAYS IN 2026-27	TEAMS	WHAT IT MEANS FOR A LIST
DIVISION 1, OPTED IN	No aid cap. A roster limit of 18 players on aid in any amount, up from the old 12 scholarships. In place since 1 July 2025.	348	The scarce thing is a seat. A girl can be offered a small amount and still be one of the 18.
DIVISION 1, NOT OPTED IN	No roster limit, and the school must stay under the old aid value. About 17 schools were named as objectors in the settlement, and there is no printed list of who chose which.	(inside 348)	Ask the question in Chapter 7. The answer changes the offer.
DIVISION 2	8.0 aid equivalents, cut into pieces. No roster limit.	288	A staff can spread 8.0 over 19 players. Half of this ladder is talk.
DIVISION 3	No athletic aid at all, and no roster limit.	417	The biggest door, and the one families walk past.
NAIA	8 aid equivalents, and no roster limit.	226 schools	Small staffs. A coach often answers her directly.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	14, and athletes named as exempt do not count against it. The published table is inside a login.	about 300 to 545	Two counts are in circulation. Chapter 11 says so.

Team counts are the NCAA's own sport page, checked 11 November 2026: 348 in Division I, 288 in Division II, 417 in Division III, 1,053 in all. The NAIA and junior college counts come from one recruiting service, which is why they are shown as a range.

A NUMBER WORTH CARRYING INTO EVERY CONVERSATION

Women's volleyball's old Division I limit was **12 scholarships**. The figure 4.5, which many sites repeat, is **men's** volleyball's old limit. Both are in the same bylaw, so a secondary source mixes them up easily. If a guide tells a family that women's volleyball was a 4.5 sport, the rest of that guide is not worth the paper.

WHO ELSE HOLDS THOSE SEATS

Before a coach spends one of the 18 spots on a 12th grader, two other lines are already in front of her.

- **Returning players.** Recruiters from four programs, two of them Division I, said players who return are counted first, no matter what the offer was last year. A staff that already has three experienced outsides may take only one.
- **Transfers.** There is no limit on one-time transfers any more, and the 2026-27 Division I portal for this sport has two windows: 6 December 2026 to 4 January 2027, and 1 to 15 May 2027. Almost 10,000 players used the portal across sports in one winter, and a recruiting-service coach says some Division I programs replace about half the roster each year. A seat that looks open in February may be gone in May.
- **Walk-ons and late adds.** Roster limits only bite after a school submits its roster, which for Division I was 2 October 2026 and for Division II is the fifth Sunday in March. A spring camp can legally hold more players than the limit, and a coach can add players after the season if they do not use a countable spot.

2. HOW MANY PLAYERS A TEAM CAN TAKE, PART 2: REAL ROSTERS

Rules say what a school may carry. Published rosters say what it does carry. These are 11 live roster pages this book counted on 11 November 2026, across four levels and in the same part of the country, plus national averages from one service. Nothing here is a rule, and no school on her list has to look like this. Count the same thing on the pages of the schools she actually wants. It takes an evening.

LEVEL	PAGES COUNTED	ROSTER SIZES	WHAT THE COUNT SHOWS
DIVISION I	6	18, 18, 16, 16, 15, 15	Two sit on the new limit exactly, four sit under it. Two belong to conferences that were in the first group to opt in.
DIVISION II	1	19	More bodies than the 8.0 aid units, which is normal at this level.
DIVISION III	2	19, 25	No athletic aid at all, and 19 to 25 players anyway.
NAIA	2	20, 31	One sat at No. 25 in its own preseason poll and listed a 5'1" defensive specialist. The other carried 31 players.

Those 11 pages list 212 players between them, and 212 is the height count behind Chapter 6. A twelfth page, a public university in the same area, listed 22.

National averages from one service, for scale: 18.1 in Division I, 19.3 in Division II, 18.2 in Division III, 18 in NAIA, 13 in junior college. No rule forces any of these numbers.

SO HOW LONG SHOULD HER LIST BE?

This book's guidance, not a rule: 40 to 60 schools across all five levels, most of them schools whose staff has already answered an email. There are 1,053 NCAA teams in this sport, plus NAIA and junior college. A girl who can pass and play defense in the back row is a fit at far more programs than the ten her uncle has heard of. Writing to twelve schools and calling it a plan is the single most common mistake in this sport.

WHAT THE ODDS REALLY SAY

492,799 girls played volleyball on a high school team in 2024-25, by the federation that runs state associations. The NCAA counted 19,810 volleyball players across its three divisions in 2023-24. That is about 4.0 percent of the high school number reaching an NCAA team: about 1.3 percent in Division I, 1.2 percent in Division II, 1.6 percent in Division III. The coaches' association, counting 2019, put the odds at a college team at 4.6 percent and at Division I at 0.6 percent, because their denominator also counted club players.

Read those as directions, not promises. The 4.0 percent figure divides a school-team count by a later roster count, ignores NAIA and junior college, and misses the club player who plays only club. The real share is smaller.

IF THERE IS A BROTHER

The men's road is a different map: about 31 Division I and 41 Division II programs, and the two divisions share one national championship of 12 teams. Division III is 141 programs, more than four times the total above it. The real pathway is male club and the National Club Volleyball Federation, which lists 616 teams at 424 schools. One campus club team has won that federation's top division, in 2023 and again in 2025. Men are usually sized up at 15 or 16 and offered later, because men keep growing. One association guide says fewer than 5 percent of high school volleyball players of either sex make a college roster. Treat any boys figure from this book as thinner evidence than the girls numbers.

3. THE PLAN BY DATE, CLASS OF 2029

She is in 10th grade this year, so every date below is real for her. Rows tagged PROJECTED are worked out from rule text the NCAA has not printed for 2028-29 yet. Rows tagged OPEN or HARD are printed by the body that runs the event. Check each one again inside six months of the date.

WHEN	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT YOUR FAMILY DOES
NOW HARD	Club season is under way. One region's club play runs from late October to early March, and its 2027-28 window is already printed as 29 October 2027 to 5 March 2028. Her high school season closed in early November, on the date her state association set.	Ask her club which qualifiers it enters and who pays for them. Club tryouts are in the fall, with fees from $25 to $70 at one club.
NOV TO DEC 2026 HARD	The Eligibility Center has a free Profile Page for anyone under 13, and a paid certification account when she is sure. The live page shows $120 for the combined account, where the 2024-25 guide still says $110.	Open the free page now. Register for certification before the spring of 11th grade. Ask for a fee waiver if the family needs one; a student may use up to two, and nobody asks the parents for income paperwork.
17-19 DEC 2026 HARD	The AVCA's Phenom College Preview in San Antonio: about 400 players, classes of 2027 through 2030, $259, by invitation or nomination. 2026 nominations closed in late October.	Ask her club coach and two high school coaches to nominate her for December 2027 now. This is the event the association says draws the most college staffs in one place.
9-10 JAN 2027 HARD	A region's own league event, number one of several, all ages. Your region publishes its dates in the fall.	Nothing. Be there, and make sure her club's schedule link works.
15 JAN 2027 HARD	NIKE Winterfest showcase in Hartford, Connecticut, for classes of 2027 through 2029, capped at 200 players. $125 by 1 January, then $175 by 9 January.	Decide by 1 January. Pay for one showcase, not four, and only if staffs she is serious about are announced.
29-31 JAN AND 12-14 MAR 2027 HARD	Northern Lights, Minneapolis, a USA Volleyball national qualifier. The January weekend covers 17s and 18s; the March weekend adds 16 Open and 16 USA.	Watch from the stands and learn what a college staff watches. Entry is $925 per team, so the club pays and the family pays travel.
7 FEB 2027 HARD	The Premier Academy event in Maumee, Ohio, for classes of 2027 through 2030, split into first, second and third teams. $145 by 9 January, then $165.	A second-team spot at a well-run event beats a first-team spot at a weak one. Ask who is coming before paying.
27-28 FEB 2027 HARD	Her region's qualifier, in a rented convention center, with only that region's teams playing. At one region the 16s bids on offer were one National, two American and one Freedom.	This is her year to earn a bid to a national qualifier, because a 16-year-old who makes the July national is on schedule. Team entry there is $925. Ask what a bid is worth in your own region before you pay.

WHEN	WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHAT YOUR FAMILY DOES
6-21 MAR 2027 HARD	Region Championships over three weekends. Bids to the 17s and 18s Junior Nationals come from these weekends and from Northern Lights and Windy City.	Send the schedule to every coach on her list the week before. Coaches come to what is on a calendar they can find.
27-29 MAR 2027 HARD	Windy City Invitational in Chicago, another national qualifier.	Second travel weekend of the spring. Book the hotel early; a big-city qualifier trip ran $670 to $830 for one family at one event.
PROJECTED 15 JUN 2027	The first day a Division I or Division II coach may answer her email or text. USA Volleyball prints the rule as 15 June after the player's sophomore year.	Send the full round that week: film, current grades, unweighted Grade Point Average on a 4.0 scale, measured height and approach touch with the device and date, and the club schedule.
JUN 2027 HARD	Her counselor uploads the 9th-grade transcript, the record after four semesters. Registration must be open at least 60 days before the upload is due.	Put the date in the counselor's calendar in the fall, not in June.
2-5 JUL 2027 HARD	USA Volleyball Girls 14-17s Junior National Championships in Las Vegas, for 16s and 17s. Registration opened 9 December 2026 at 11 a.m. Eastern.	The alternative is AAU's 16s and 17s event in Orlando, 25 to 28 June 2027. Both are seen. Ask which one the staffs she wants attend, and pick that one.
PROJECTED 1 AUG 2027	The first day a Division I school may host her on a visit, official or unofficial. Division II may host an official visit from 15 June. Division III may host one from 1 January of her junior year, so 1 January 2027. NAIA has no rule.	Plan the first trip around a tournament she is already playing in. A Division I school gives her five official visits in a lifetime.
AUG TO NOV 2027 OPEN	11th-grade high school season, and the year that decides her Grade Point Average the most.	Four approved core courses a year, and a counselor who checks every credit against the NCAA list. A 2.3 core Grade Point Average is the Division I floor and 2.2 is the Division II floor. No SAT or ACT is required for anyone first enrolling on or after 1 August 2023.
JUN 2028 HARD	The counselor uploads the record after six semesters.	Check the Eligibility Center page shows both transcripts. A missing upload has cost players a signing day.
PROJECTED WED 8 NOV 2028	Signed, and the other schools must stop recruiting her. The rule is the second Wednesday in November, which is the date the NCAA printed for this year as 11 November 2026. The 2028-29 sheet is not out. February 2029 is football's signing period, not this one.	Ask for the number and the date in the same email in September 2028. If a coach says "we want you" and no paper follows, the coach is still shopping.
APR 2029 HARD	From 1 April of her graduation year she may ask the Eligibility Center for her final athletics certification.	Ask for it before the deposit, not after. Graduate, finish all 16 approved subjects, and do not let the final semester fall.

WHAT A MISSED DATE COSTS

A late transcript upload delays certification, and a certification that is not final means a signed paper may not hold. A missed regional qualifier can cost the whole summer's showcase in Las Vegas, and bidding down from another event can run as late as the first week of May. A girl who is not measured, not registered and not on a schedule by the spring of 11th grade starts the year that decides everything with a handicap no money can fully fix.

4. WHAT A COACH MAY AND MAY NOT DO

CHECKED 11 NOVEMBER 2026 AGAINST USA VOLLEYBALL'S RECRUITING TIMELINE AND THE PRINTED 2026-27 DIVISION I CALENDAR FOR THIS SPORT.

In this sport the rule is not "no contact." It is "she may talk, and the coach may not answer for two more years." Almost every confused email a staff gets comes from a family that learned the rule backwards.

WHO	FROM WHEN	PLAIN WORDS
SHE MAY WRITE	Today, any year	USA Volleyball prints "NO RESTRICTIONS" for a recruit contacting a coach at any level. Email, text, direct message, phone, all fine.
A D1 OR D2 COACH MAY ANSWER	15 June after her 10th grade, so 15 June 2027	The governing body's words: coaches "cannot directly communicate with recruits or their families" before that day. That covers phone and text, not just email.
A D3, NAIA OR JUNIOR COLLEGE COACH MAY ANSWER	Any time	These programs are not held to the same contact date, and one service lists camp invites as something any school may send "any time."
A COACH MAY WATCH HER PLAY	Any time, in person	Spectator seating at her club event is not recruiting contact. This is why the club schedule matters more than the camp brochure.

VISITS, AND WHO PAYS

LEVEL	FIRST ALLOWED DATE	WHAT A FAMILY SHOULD KNOW
DIVISION 1	1 August before her 11th grade, so 1 August 2027. Both kinds of visit.	She gets five official visits in a lifetime, and the school pays for those. She needs a paid certification account to take one. Unofficial visits she may take at any cost to herself from the same date.
DIVISION 2	Official visits after 15 June of her 10th-grade year.	Earlier than Division I, and a real lever if a Division II staff is honest with her in June 2027.
DIVISION 3	Official visits after 1 January of her 11th-grade year.	No athletic money, so the trip is about the school and the roster. Ask about academic and need aid in the same email.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	Official visits after the first day of classes of her 11th-grade year.	Ask the college, not the club coach, what the trip covers.
NAIA	No rule printed.	Small staffs, and the head coach usually answers her own email.

CONTACT PERIODS AND DEAD PERIODS

The printed 2026-27 Division I calendar for this sport shows a contact period from 1 September to 30 November and a dead period from 9 to 12 November 2026, which is the week of this year's signing date. In a contact period a staff may talk to her face to face on campus. In a dead period it may not talk to her at all, in person or on the phone. The calendar for her own signing week is not printed yet. The rule text is stable; the dates move a day or two a year.

THE CAMP RULE, WITH A FLAG ON IT

The coaches' association said in April 2022 that a Division I volleyball camp may only run between Memorial Day and 31 July, and that "recruiting conversations during an institutional camp or clinic are not permitted between an institution's coach and a participating individual before August 1 at the beginning of the individual's junior year." A campus tour for all campers is allowed. **This book could not re-check that against the 2026-27 rule book.** Assume the talk is off limits at a summer 2027 camp until 1 August 2027, even though phone and email open on 15 June 2027, and ask the director at the front desk.

THREE LIMITS ON HOW HARD A STAFF MAY PUSH

- A signed aid agreement with one school makes every other school that offers athletics aid stop recruiting her and her family. To talk to another school she must first get a release from the one she signed.
- Once a school's roster is submitted, its limit applies. A staff that promises a spot past its own limit is promising something it may not be able to deliver that fall.
- Anything a school gives her above tuition and fees is now a separate contract in most programs. Read it on its own, and ask what happens to it if she is hurt or if the coach leaves.

WHAT YOUR FAMILY MUST NOT DO

- Do not sign two junior college letters of intent. It costs a year of ineligibility in that association.
- Do not hire an agent for a high school athlete. One state association lets her do endorsements, but not with the school's name, uniform or logo, not paid for performance, and not through an agent. Another state may be stricter than that, and the NCAA is stricter than both.
- Do not let a parent send the email and stay silent. Coaches say they want the player's own words, and one Division III coach wrote that "the VAST majority of recruits emailing are not recruits we'd pursue."
- Do not treat the division's rule as the school's rule. A conference may set a lower roster limit than 18, and each school decides its own aid.

5. CLUB, REGION, CAMPS, AND WHERE SHE IS ACTUALLY SEEN

One number should settle the argument at the dinner table. In the NCAA's 2025 participation study, 94 percent of college volleyball players played both high school and club, 3 percent played high school only, and 2 percent played club only. USA Volleyball repeats the same finding as "more than 90%." The club season is the showcase. The high school season is where she gets better and stays healthy.

THE SHAPE OF THE YEAR, IN ANY STATE

In one state the 2026 season ran from the earliest practice on 17 August to the showpiece tournament on 5 to 7 November, played as a bracket in a rented arena. Every state association sets its own calendar: most run a fall season between late August and early November, some split schools into as many as eleven classes, and some run one open class where a small school can win it all. Then club tryouts. One club posted tryouts for 14 November 2026 and a second chance on 19 November, with fees from $25 to $70. Club play then runs into the spring. Two years of dates ahead are rarely printed, so treat her last two fall calendars as PROJECTED and ask her own association for its published schedule.

One of the largest club regions in the country reported 18,137 members and 148 clubs at the end of 2024-25, and listed 14,628 youth girls in its May 2026 newsletter. Coaches know numbers like this. A girl from a small club is not unseen because of her club; she is unseen because nobody sent her film.

THE LADDER, IN THE ORDER IT ACTUALLY HAPPENS

1. **Club tryout in the fall.** The team decides which tournaments she is seen at. Ask, before paying, which qualifiers the team enters.
2. **A regional league weekend in January.** One region's own league event is 9 to 10 January 2027, all ages. Your region publishes dates like this one in the fall.
3. **Her region's qualifier, 27 to 28 February 2027, in a rented convention center.** Only that region's teams play. At one region the 16s age group had four bids on offer for the July national: one National, two American, one Freedom. Extra bids trickle down from other teams and can arrive as late as the first week of May. Team entry there is $925. Ask what a bid is worth in your own region before the family pays.
4. **Region Championships, 6 to 21 March 2027, over three weekends.** This is where 17s and 18s earn their way to Junior Nationals.
5. **A national qualifier if the club goes:** Northern Lights in Minneapolis, 29 to 31 January and 12 to 14 March 2027, or the Windy City Invitational in Chicago, 27 to 29 March 2027.
6. **Junior Nationals.** USA Volleyball's Girls 14-17s event in Las Vegas, 2 to 5 July 2027 for 16s and 17s, with registration that opened 9 December 2026 at 11 a.m. Eastern. AAU's 16s and 17s event in Orlando runs 25 to 28 June 2027. Staffs work both.

WHERE A STAFF SAYS IT LOOKS

A Texas State assistant coach and recruiting coordinator wrote for the coaches' association that her staff faced "over 150 club tournaments between Jan. 1 and Aug. 1 alone, plus you have to factor in camps and clinics." That is the market. A club coach's advice, repeated by several staffs: build a free Otto Prep profile, the platform formerly called University Athlete, because "this is how coaches at the tournaments locate you." The same page shows her schedule, her club team and her grades without another email. A Stanford head coach says on that company's own site that it is "the first place we look to find athletes," and the company gives every athlete a free profile.

A CAMP INVITE IS NOT INTEREST, AND THIS IS NOT AN OPINION

USA Volleyball, in its own recruiting Q&A: "an invitation to a camp may or may not indicate interest, and you should follow up with an email or phone call for more information." The Junior Volleyball Association puts it harder: if she has "not already received a lot of interest from this college program prior to receiving the camp brochure, do not assume this school is recruiting you." Every camp site checked for this book says the camp is open to any and all entrants, limited only by number and age group. One region's own summer camp page adds a warning about its own listings: "All listings are paid advertisements."

What is real activity, per USA Volleyball: a coach watching her profile, replying to an email, or asking for film or her schedule. That is "at least a moderate level of interest." A mail-merged brochure is not.

WHAT CAMPS COST, SO THE MATH IS PLAIN

A private university's college prep camp in July was $310 commuting and $380 resident, open to grades 9 to 12 with high-level club or varsity experience, and the page says each camper "will be evaluated." Its one-day passers camp was $60 and its overnight satellite camp was $200. A public university's prospect camp was $160 for 40 players, lunch included. A Division III school's camp was $154 for one session and $318 for two. A Division I position camp ran $375 to $485. A flagship campus filled a week of June and July 2026 with its own camps, and the June packet says the camp is "recommended only" for players who compete at the club level and in high-level national events. One campus camp was not open to everyone at all: $342 and $447, by invitation. Prices for 2027 were not posted at any of these schools when this book was checked, so read them as the shape of the market, not as a quote.

ASK THESE FOUR THINGS ON ANY VISIT OR CALL

- How many players are you signing in my class, at my position, and who is already ahead of me?
- What does the aid look like in year one, and how is it renewed?
- What happens to the promise if you leave, and who do I talk to then?
- Which dates in 2028 can I come back on an official visit, and does the school pay?

6. WHAT TO SEND, PART 1: THE EMAIL

One email, from her, with two links. It is short because a staff gets hundreds of them a week. Everything a coach skims for sits in the first four lines, and every number says how it was measured.

SUBJECT LINE, 74 LETTERS

2029 outside hitter / DS at Anytown South HS · 5'11", 9'4" approach · 3.62 GPA · film inside

BODY, 175 WORDS, FROM HER OWN MAILBOX

Coach Rivera,

My name is Madison Weber. I play outside hitter and defensive specialist at Anytown South High School. I graduate in 2029. My club team is Impact Athletic Development 16 Orange, and my schedule is in the link below.

Club numbers, 71 sets: 3.08 kills a set, .271 hitting on 640 swings, 3.48 digs a set, 18 aces, 41 serve errors. In serve receive, 268 passes, 104 perfect on a 3-point scale.

Measures, 22 May 2027, by my trainer at Impact Athletic Development: 5'11" barefoot, 7'6" standing reach in shoes with feet flat, 9'4" approach touch on a Vertec, best of four.

Unweighted GPA 3.62 on a 4.0 scale. NCAA ID 7419286. I want to study nursing.

I watched your matches on the stream this fall. Your April update said one outside spot is open for 2029. May I send a full match, and how many outsides are you signing that year?

Reel, 2:40, no login: youtu.be/xxxxxxx
Free profile: ottoprep.com/xxxxxxx

Thank you for reading this.

Madison Weber
madison.weber@example.com · (555) 555-0148

Invented player, invented school, invented club, invented coach, per this book's rule: sample emails name no real high school, club, camp or service. The numbers are the kind a 16s outside hitter really posts, and the links are placeholders.

WHY IT IS WRITTEN THIS WAY

- **She writes it.** A Division III head coach who won a national title said he can "tell the email that dad sent with your name on it." A club coach says the same: "we can tell if a parent wrote them."
- **Position, class and height in the subject.** A club coach's rule is to put name, position and grade year in the subject line and to spell the position out, because "coaches will not know" what OH/RS means at a glance. Balltime's guide says the same, and adds that coaches skim for the video link, the class year, the height and approach touch, the grades, and one real reason she likes that school.
- **Stats with denominators.** "3.08 kills a set" over 71 sets is a claim a coach can weigh. The same number from six sets is noise.
- **Numbers with a method and a date.** See the box below. This is where most families lose credit.
- **One question a coach can answer in five words.** A recruiting-coordinator note in the sample assumes the staff has posted a needs list. If it has not, ask for it.
- **No attachments, and no login walls.** The Junior Volleyball Association's coach-sourced list says do not send video that needs a sign-in. Unlisted YouTube, or a public Balltime or Hudl page, and test the link in a signed-out browser on a phone first.

LABEL EVERY NUMBER, OR A COACH DISCOUNTS ALL OF THEM

Two studies found that a wearable jump device reads about two inches higher than a Vertec for the same athlete, one of them on 128 Brazilian youth national players at 70.9 centimetres against 76.3. So "vertical 24 inches" means nothing without the tool. Say the tool, the date, who measured, and whether the shoes were on. A bare-height claim should be measured barefoot to the nearest half inch, with a parent writing it down.

One more reason to be honest: this book counted 212 listed heights across 11 nearby college rosters, then counted the NCAA's own national leader lists. Division I shows a bump at exactly 6'0" over 5'11" (143 players against 93), which fits rounding up and does not prove it. If a roster says 6'0" and she is 5'11" in socks, she is not short. Her number, honestly measured, is worth more than a hopeful one.

6. WHAT TO SEND, PART 2: WHAT GOOD VIDEO LOOKS LIKE

Coaches say two to five minutes, and no two sources agree on the number. The shortest honest number in this research is two minutes, from the company that has the most profiles. Build two to three minutes, best clips first, and keep the full match ready to send when a coach asks.

POSITION	WHAT MUST BE IN THE REEL	WHY
OUTSIDE HITTER	Attack from both pins, block, serve, and serve receive and defense. Variety of shots.	A coach who recruits outsides said: "include variety in your videos. I once got a video where the recruit literally hit the same shot in every clip."
SETTER	Setting from both front and back row, out of system, to every antenna, plus defense, blocking and any serving.	In and out of system is the whole question at this position.
MIDDLE	Quick attack, block footwork, transition, handling a free ball, and the serve.	The club-coach checklist for middles is exactly these five things.
OPPOSITE	Right-pin attack against a full block, block, serve.	Same list as an outside, minus the passing.
LIBERO AND DS	Serve receive from every zone, defense from deep and shallow, vision, and the serve if the staff wants it. Passing and defense above everything.	"If you are a Libero, please include passing and defense." A Division I head coach of a national champion said of liberos: "we don't care if they can jump."

THE RULES NEARLY EVERY COACH STATED

- Match play, not drills. Controlled-drill clips "do not give them a good sense of your overall athletic ability, decision making and reactions to errors." Reps from a live practice game are fine and preferred.
- Show a few seconds before and after the ball. One coach: "I want to see your body language, communication with teammates and reactions." A Division III national-champion coach wants an entire point, not a highlight, plus her jersey number, jersey color and side of the court.
- No slow motion, no music, no big arrows. Several coaches say they mute the audio anyway.
- Put her name, position, class and jersey number on the first frame. Otto Prep's own advice: a cover card "to remind them who they are watching before the clips start," because "coaches are not going to sit there and fast forward through full matches trying to find your five touches."
- Skip the flashy passing clips. A coach on the record: "Highlight clips of passing and digging aren't really of all that much value, especially the flashy ones. For all I know, you shanked all your other opportunities."
- Expect to be judged in seconds. One service measured that coaches watch "the first 10-25 seconds" of a reel; a club coach says 10 to 15. The fix is the same: the best clip goes first.

TWO COACHES DISAGREE ABOUT KILLS. BOTH ARE ON THE RECORD.

One recruiting site tells players that every hit shown should be a kill. A coach who has scouted for years says kills and aces alone do not show skill, and wants mechanics, movement and what happens after the error. This book prints the second advice, because the first comes from a company selling a service and the second comes from a coach. Send the reel to a school you like and ask what it wants. The answer costs a coach ten seconds and is worth more than any guide.

6. WHAT TO SEND, PART 3: SIZE, JUMP AND STATS, HONESTLY

NO COLLEGE IN THIS RESEARCH PUBLISHES AN APPROACH, BLOCK OR REACH STANDARD. NOTHING BELOW IS A RULE.

Two kinds of number exist. The first is what a school lists on its own roster, which this book counted. The second is what a recruiting company hopes for, which is one company's target. The columns say which is which.

POSITION	COUNTED ROSTER HEIGHTS, 11 NEARBY TEAMS	A SERVICE'S TARGET: TOP DIVISION I	SAME SERVICE: DIVISION II, NAIA, STRONG DIVISION III	SAME SERVICE: DIVISION III AND JUNIOR COLLEGE
OUTSIDE	Top Division I 5'10" to 6'6", middle of the list 6'2". Smaller-conference Division I 5'8" to 6'2", middle 6'0". Division III middle 5'11". NAIA middle 5'10".	5'11" to 6'2" and a 9'8" or better approach SERVICE	5'8" to 5'10" and a 9'4" approach SERVICE	5'8" to 5'10" and a 9'0" approach SERVICE
MIDDLE	Top Division I 6'1" to 6'5", middle 6'3". Division III 5'10" to 6'2", middle 6'0". NAIA middle 6'0".	6'0" to 6'4" and taller, 10'0" or better SERVICE	5'9" to 6'1" SERVICE	5'9" to 6'1" and a 9'4" approach SERVICE
SETTER	Top Division I 5'8" to 6'3", middle 5'11". Smaller-conference Division I middle 5'8". Division III middle 5'9". NAIA middle 5'8".	5'9" to 6'1" and taller, 9'6" approach SERVICE	5'7" to 5'10" and a 9'2" approach SERVICE	5'4" to 5'10" and an 8'10" approach SERVICE
LIBERO, DS	Top Division I 5'3" to 5'10", middle 5'8", with one 6'3" defensive specialist at Minnesota. Division III 5'3" to 5'8", middle 5'7". NAIA 5'1" to 5'10", middle 5'5".	5'5" to 6'0", no jump number given SERVICE	5'0" to 5'8", no jump number SERVICE	5'0" to 5'8", "lateral quickness" named as the key SERVICE

Roster heights are this book's own count of 212 listed heights at 11 programs in one part of the country, read 11 November 2026. Targets are one company's positional guidelines; a second company's chart is close but not the same, and a third prints a row labeled "weight" that clearly holds heights. That is the whole state of the art.

THE LIBERO QUESTION, ANSWERED WITH NAMES

This book counted the 147 players listed as libero or defensive specialist among the top 150 in Division I digs per set. Their listed heights run from 5'0" to 6'0", with a middle of 5'6". Thirty-two are 5'4" or shorter, and 23 are 5'9" or taller. The Division I No. 1, St. John's libero Rashanny Solano Smith, is listed 5'3" at 5.44 digs a set; No. 5, Abilene Christian's Brennan Ramirez, 5'1"; No. 7, Binghamton's Celeste Ocampo, 5'0"; Idaho State's Aspen Boice, 6'0". The national governing body says most nations' women's liberos average about 5'7". The Division I coach of three national champions at Nebraska says it plainly: "Liberos, we don't care if they can jump, so we're looking at how well they can move and what kind of touch they have on a ball." An NAIA head coach goes the other way for the same position: "I am all for the bigger being on the court. There are six-footers who basically own that position." Both are quoted. Neither is a rule.

WHAT THE NCAA'S OWN LEADER LISTS LOOK LIKE

These are cut lines on the national lists through games of 10 November 2026, the season she is watching now. A girl at the No. 100 line of a division is close to the best player in that division, not average.

STAT	DIVISION 1, NO. 1 / 25 / 50 / 100	DIVISION 2, SAME RANKS	DIVISION 3, SAME RANKS	WHAT A COACH READS AROUND IT
KILLS PER SET	5.21 / 4.30 / 3.97 / 3.63	4.55 / 3.85 / 3.56 / 3.28	5.69 / 3.96 / 3.69 / 3.36	86 of the Division I top 100 are outside hitters, so this is an outside's list.
HITTING PERCENTAGE	.519 / .405 / .379 / .350	.434 / .379 / .361 / .328	.427 / .353 / .336 / .311	89 of the Division I top 100 are middles. A quick-set middle beats a pin hitter here every year.
ASSISTS PER SET	11.73 / 10.51 / 10.01 / 9.12	11.68 / 10.18 / 9.30 / 7.45	11.03 / 9.23 / 8.45 / 7.09	Says little about a setter. Ask a staff what they want to see out of system.
DIGS PER SET	5.44 / 4.69 / 4.36 / 4.01	7.17 / 5.15 / 4.90 / 4.33	6.31 / 5.35 / 4.93 / 4.49	A libero on a team that gets hit at digs more. One coach wants dig-to-kill, 32 to 38 percent.
ACES PER SET	0.74 / 0.51 / 0.45 / 0.39	0.71 / 0.53 / 0.48 / 0.43	0.94 / 0.71 / 0.65 / 0.56	The error count matters as much. The sample email in this chapter prints 18 aces against 41 serve errors.

THE PASSING NUMBERS COACHES HAVE SAID OUT LOUD

A former USC head coach and 2000 Olympic women's coach: "At the collegiate level, we look for anybody who can get a perfect pass 62 to 66 percent of the time." A former Penn State head coach, on a 3-point scale: "if one libero is passing a 2.2 and another is passing 2.3, but the 2.2 does not get aced, then I am going with the 2.2." An NAIA head coach: "I don't have a magic number. I am looking for a person who might have a reception error once every three matches."

None of these are transferable between programs, because the pass scale is not standard. Some coaches score 0 to 3, some 0 to 4. Print the scale with the number, and never print "passing 2.5" alone.

HOW MUCH TALLER WILL SHE BE?

Pediatric sources agree on the shape: most girls grow one to two more inches after the first period and reach final adult height around 14 or 15, with a wide tail. One study of 793 Swedish women found a middle of about 2.8 inches of growth left after the first period, and a range from almost none to more than a foot. A pediatrician can plot her growth chart, and a hand X-ray can estimate when growth ends. So her 10th-grade height is not her college height, and a coach who sizes her up at 15 may be wrong by two inches. The Montana associate head coach quoted above said it another way: "we want to see you get kills and pass dimes, but we are really watching how you move."

6. WHAT TO SEND, PART 4: WHAT LEAVES HER OUT, AND HOW TO FOLLOW UP

Coaches told this book, and told the industry's own association, the same ten things that make them stop reading. Every one is free to fix.

1. **Practice clips.** One coach: clips of a coach feeding her easy balls "don't give me much to go on." Reps from a live practice game are fine; a controlled drill is not.
2. **The same shot in every clip.** The coach who said he once got a reel where the player hit the same shot on every rep is recruiting variety, not one weapon.
3. **A passing number with no scale and no errors.** See the box in part 3.
4. "**I am a great teammate and love to compete.**" One platform's guide calls this a statement "anyone can make." Add a story, or cut it.
5. **A money question in email one.** Ask about aid after a staff shows interest, and ask it on the visit, in the same breath as academics.
6. "**I will play anywhere you need me.**" A staff recruiting an outside hears: no position. Name the two positions she can actually play.
7. **The wrong mascot, or a major the school does not offer.** A club coach's list of quick ways to lose a staff.
8. **An attachment, or a link that needs a sign-in.** One platform's support page explains why a profile link can require a login; a coach will not create an account to find her. Send an unlisted YouTube link or a public page.
9. **A parent's mailbox and a To: line full of 40 coaches.** One coach's line about the emails his staff receives: "I can tell the email that dad sent with your name on it." Send one email to one named coach.
10. **A whole club roster and a birth-certificate mismatch.** Use the name on her transcript and her profile, because that is the name the Eligibility Center checks.

HOW TO FOLLOW UP, AND HOW LONG TO WAIT

An advisor who has coached in this sport for decades and sells coaching says: before the June date, email every two weeks, first an introduction and then updates with and without video; in 11th and 12th grade, every week to two weeks; and "if you haven't heard anything back after 5-8 emails, you can drop the school." Her other rule is worth taping to the monitor: "always be the last one to make contact." A Division III national-champion coach adds the other half: "I shouldn't have to wait a week to hear back from you." Answer inside a day, and send the update the day after the tournament.

WHAT THE SILENCE PROBABLY MEANS

Named Division III coaches have said the quiet part. Trinity's head coach: "The VAST majority of recruits emailing are not recruits we'd pursue." A Division III head coach at a public university: there is volume, "but not many of those emails equate to roster spots." A Kean coach said a little over 60 percent of the emails his staff gets are defensive specialists, which is worth knowing before a family chooses that position. These quotes came from a coaches' column kept off the association's own site, so weigh them as coaches talking to peers.

The published numbers on email volume all come from companies selling recruiting tools, and none is volleyball-specific. One measured that coaches opened about 46 percent of athlete emails, that players who emailed 50 or more coaches heard back 82 percent of the time against 7 percent for those who emailed one to nine, and that a single follow-up roughly tripled the reply rate. A soccer company's study of 3,782 emails to 1,057 coaches found 23.7 percent of coaches replied at all, only 5.7 percent showed genuine interest, the middle wait for a first reply was almost nine days, and 42 percent of replies came more than a month later. Real interest showed at Division III 11.7 percent of the time against 2.8 percent at Division I.

WHAT TO DO WITH THOSE NUMBERS

Read them as directions, not promises. The player who emails 50 schools and gets 82 percent replies is also the player who measures her jump, uploads her transcript on time and plays on a team that enters qualifiers; the company that counted the emails cannot separate the two. What is safe to conclude: write to more schools than feels polite, follow up once with something new, expect a slow answer, and do not spend money to be "prioritized" in somebody's inbox.

7. WHAT THE PAPERWORK REALLY MEANS

One paper, one school, one date. Everything else a family is told to sign is either a celebration or a two-year-college contract. This chapter is the shortest path to not being surprised.

THE PAPER, AND THE DATE

The National Letter of Intent is gone. The NCAA ended it in October 2024, and Division II made the same change the same month. What she signs at a Division I or II school is a written offer of athletics aid. The NCAA's own scholarships page still says Division II schools "may still use" the old letter, so ask each Division II school which paper it uses. The first day she may sign is the second Wednesday in November of 12th grade. The NCAA published 11 November 2026 for that rule this year, which makes her date **Wednesday 8 November 2028**, marked PROJECTED because the 2028-29 sheet is not out. The period then stays open, with the final date set by each school, so she can sign in December. The calendar also puts a dead period on the Monday through Thursday of the week of that first signing day, which for her would be 6 to 9 November 2028 by the same arithmetic. February 2029 is football's month, not hers.

WHAT THE SETTLEMENT CHANGED, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

From 1 July 2025 there are no sport-by-sport scholarship limits in Division I. A school that opts in to the settlement takes a roster limit instead, 18 for women's volleyball, and may give aid to any or all of those players in any amount. The limit counts every player on the submitted roster, with or without aid, and a roster spot is not guaranteed to anyone. Opting in is a decision for the whole school, not one sport, and it is revisited each year for ten years. A conference may set a lower limit than 18 but not below 12. Separate from all of this, each school may share up to $20.5 million with athletes in 2025-26, rising each year. That money is its own contract, and the school's own Q&A says so.

WHAT SHE ACTUALLY GETS IF SHE SIGNS

- Aid "if you are admitted, remain eligible and meet the terms." Read the terms. The NCAA tells students to.
- Every other school that gives athletics aid must stop recruiting her and her family. She cannot sign twice; to talk to anyone else she needs a release from the school she signed.
- At Division I, if she received aid in her first year and still has eligibility, that aid cannot be reduced, canceled or not renewed for athletics reasons. The list of athletics reasons includes injury, illness, mental health, performance, contribution to team success and roster management. A school must give written notice and a chance to appeal, and notice not to renew comes by 1 July.
- The same rule set says a player on aid who loses her spot to roster management, performance or injury keeps her scholarship "unless and until the student chooses to transfer."
- Division I schools must cover medical care for athletics injuries and eligible out-of-pocket costs, and continue that care for at least two years after she leaves. The NCAA adds catastrophic and post-eligibility insurance at no cost to her.

REDSHIRT IS GONE FOR HER CLASS

Division I adopted an age-based eligibility model in June 2026, effective 1 August 2026, and Division II followed in August 2026. The five-year clock starts at the earlier of her first full-time enrollment at any college, a two-year college included, or the school year after her 19th birthday. It does not pause if she sits out or transfers. The NCAA says the rule is not "five years for everyone" and that redshirt rules, seasons of competition and most waivers are eliminated. Division II's old 10-semester cap is gone too.

Two things follow. A coach cannot offer her "a redshirt year" the way families heard it from older coaches. And a junior-college year starts the clock, so one year at a two-year college leaves four, not five. Anyone who tells her a junior college year buys an extra season is working from the old rule book.

THE OTHER LEVELS, ON ONE PAGE

LEVEL	WHAT SHE SIGNS	WHAT TO KNOW FIRST
DIVISION 1	Written offer of athletics aid, from 8 November 2028 (PROJECTED).	Needs a certified Eligibility Center account, which also gates her official visits. Her school's academic record is checked against 16 approved subjects, a 2.3 core Grade Point Average, and graduation.
DIVISION 2	Written offer of aid. Ask whether the school still uses the old letter.	The core floor is 2.2. Transcripts and the account work the same way.
DIVISION 3	Nothing binding. A nonbinding celebratory form may be signed after she is accepted.	No athletic aid, and no Eligibility Center certificate for a domestic athlete: the school certifies her. About 80 percent of Division III athletes do receive non-athletic aid. A coach's "offer" usually means support with admissions, and a support letter is not admission.
NAIA	The school's own paper. The NAIA has no letter-of-intent program.	The national office says it "will not force a school to honor a financial aid agreement." Registration is $110 for a U.S. high school graduate. The academic floor is a 2.3 Grade Point Average at graduation, or two of three: a qualifying test score, a 2.0 overall, or the top half of the class. A test score can still help here.
JUNIOR COLLEGE	The association's Letter of Intent and Scholarship Agreement, binding for one academic year, 1 August to 31 July, and it cannot be awarded before the start of senior year.	Signing two of them costs a year of eligibility in that association. A year there starts the NCAA's five-year clock. Get a release, in writing, before she leaves.

ASK THESE FIVE QUESTIONS ABOUT ANY PAPER

- What are the exact dollars, what do they cover, and is health insurance part of it?
- How is it renewed each year, and who signs the renewal?
- Is the roster spot promised, or only the money?
- What happens if you leave, coach, and who else on staff has read this contract?
- Is the revenue-share or name-and-image deal a separate contract, and what happens to it if she is hurt?

One term this book could not settle: a "letter of assurance" has no definition in any NCAA, NAIA or NJCAA material we read. Treat it as talk. And when a club page tells families that "Division III does have a National Letter of Intent," both the NCAA and a Division III school's own athletics site say the opposite.

8. WHAT IT COSTS, PART 1: PUBLISHED PRICES

Every figure here was printed by the club, school, event or seller, checked 11 November 2026. The last column is this book's opinion, and it says so.

LINE	PUBLISHED PRICE	WHO PRINTED IT	THIS BOOK'S CALL
CLUB, LOCAL OR REGIONAL	$1,350 to $2,600. One published example: $1,450 for eight league dates, with no required out-of-state travel.	Clubs	The best value per touch in the sport. Fewer showcases, so the family must send film earlier.
CLUB, MID TRAVEL	$3,100 to $4,350	Clubs	Reasonable if the team enters a regional qualifier where staffs actually go.
CLUB, NATIONAL CIRCUIT	One club on the USA Volleyball national qualifier circuit prints $4,350 for 18s and $4,950 for 15s to 17s. A second club states its range as $3,500 to $5,800 depending on team level and travel. A top 14s team at a large club: $7,380.	Clubs	Pay it for the schedule, not the label. Ask which qualifiers, and whether staffs were announced.
TRYOUT FEE	$25 to $70	Clubs	Unavoidable.
UNIFORM AND GEAR	$240 to $374 where billed separately	Clubs	Ask before signing. Some clubs roll it in, some do not.
INDIVIDUAL MEMBERSHIP	$90 in one region; another region does not publish its price	USA Volleyball region	Small line. Ask the club what it includes.
QUALIFIER ENTRY	$925 per team at a USA Volleyball national qualifier, which is about $78 to $93 a player on a 10 to 12 player roster	USA Volleyball events	The club pays it and passes it along. Know that it is in the fee.
CLUB-RUN TRAVEL EVENTS	$120 to $160 per player for a multi-day regional event; $175 to $225 for a three-day national qualifier	Clubs	Predictable. Budget it by name.

LINE	PUBLISHED PRICE	WHO PRINTED IT	THIS BOOK'S CALL
HOTEL AND GAS, FAMILY	Nothing published by any club this book checked. The only marker found: one big-city club expects $4,000 to $5,000 for six overnight tournaments, about $670 to $830 a trip.	Club disclosure	This is the real budget line for most families. Plan four trips, not fourteen camp weekends.
COLLEGE CAMP, ANY LEVEL	A private university's prep camp $310 commuting, $380 resident; its overnight satellite camp $200; its one-evening passers camp $60; a public university prospect camp $160 for 40 spots; a Division I position camp $375 to $485; a Division III camp $154 to $318; an invite-only campus camp $342 to $447.	Schools	Go after a staff answers an email. A $60 one-evening camp at the same school tells her just as much.
SHOWCASE	AVCA Phenom $259 and by invitation; Premier Academy $145 then $165; NIKE Winterfest $125 then $175, capped at 200; Hawaii Showcase $99; one service says showcases run $200 to $500.	Event organizers	One, chosen for who is announced as attending.
FILM EDIT	$20 to $60 at a freelance marketplace; $450 to $1,350 at a volleyball-specific shop; a large service says full-service production runs $500 to $1,000 or more.	Sellers	A parent with a tripod at the end line and a $55 edit beats a $1,350 reel with no live-play footage. Nobody showed that the higher price buys more looks.
PAID RECRUITING SERVICE	The market leader publishes no price. Two reports give $1,320 to $4,200 and $250 to $2,100; parents tell a volleyball site $1,000 to $6,000 a year. Complaints filed in 2026 with the Better Business Bureau include a $4,719 membership refunded 50 percent.	Reports and complaints	Buy a cheap tool or nothing. Cheaper rivals publish their prices at $19.99 to $49.99 a month.

LINE	PUBLISHED PRICE	WHO PRINTED IT	THIS BOOK'S CALL
PROFILE PLATFORM	A free athlete profile, with an all-access tier reported at $249 a year; a free profile at another platform with a paid tier reported at $99 a month or $399 a year; a video platform's player plan at $20 and its recruiting plan at $25 a month, billed $299 a year.	Sellers	Start free. Two clubs point families to these two platforms as the only recruiting tools they need.
ELIGIBILITY CENTER	$120 on the live sign-up page, $75 for athletics certification only, $110 in the association's own printed guide, and $110 at the NAIA.	NCAA, NAIA	Confirm the number on the day she pays. Fee waivers exist and need no parent income paperwork.
WATCHING THE COLLEGE	Conference streaming at $89.99 a year or $12.99 a month, and $39.99 for the 2026-27 year for verified groups such as students and alumni.	Conference	Free on a Big Ten campus. Ten minutes of film of the real team is worth more than a brochure.

8. WHAT IT COSTS, PART 2: ONE YEAR, ALL IN

This is this book's arithmetic from the published lines above, not a number a seller printed. A recruiting service claims families spend $3,000 to $10,000 a year. The build below lands inside that.

BUILD	LOW	HIGH	NOTE
CLUB, NATIONAL CIRCUIT	$4,350	$4,950	One club's published fee
UNIFORM AND GEAR, IF SEPARATE	$240	$374	Published by two clubs
INDIVIDUAL MEMBERSHIP	$90	$90	One region's price
TWO TRAVEL WEEKENDS FOR THE FAMILY	$1,340	$1,660	Two trips at the $670 to $830 marker. This book's estimate, not a price from a club she would join.
SEASON SUBTOTAL	about $6,000	about $7,100	Add one camp and one edit and the year is $6,200 to $7,900
THE SAME YEAR ON A LOCAL CLUB	about $3,300	about $5,300	$1,450 club fee, uniform, membership, two travel weekends at the same marker, one camp, one edit

THE MONEY LINE FOR THIS SPORT

The gap between a $4,350 national-circuit fee and a $1,450 local-league fee is $2,900. That is about 14 satellite camps at $200, or about nine of the same school's prep camp, or roughly 50 one-evening skills camps at $60.

A camp plus an edit costs $255 at the low end and $760 at the high, which is 6 to 17 percent of one club fee. A top-tier service at $1,320 to $4,200 costs more than the camp and the edit combined, several times over, and in this research not one college coach said on the record that a paid tier moved a volleyball recruit. What a coach did say on the record is that film, a schedule and a free profile are what get used.

NAME, IMAGE AND LIKENESS: WHAT THE MONEY REALLY IS

Do not plan a budget around this. A 2026 industry report puts the average women's volleyball deal at $663, next to $2,500 for women's basketball and $5,900 for football. A 2024 report from the same company estimated a Division I women's volleyball player's expected annual value at $5,868 and found the sport took 2.9 percent of commercial deal dollars and 0.8 percent of collective dollars. The NCAA's own NIL database for 2023-24, reported through a national outlet, put volleyball third among Power Four women's sports in reported deals at 15.2 percent, behind basketball and softball, with Power Four women's athletes averaging $7,947 in reported earnings.

Two rules matter for any 10th grader with a following. Her state high school association may let a student athlete do endorsements, but not using her school's name, uniform or logo, not paid for performance, and not through an agent. On the NCAA side, deals of $600 or more must be reported, counted from the start of 11th grade. So a local car-dealer deal is fine and a school-Logo deal is not. Ask before she signs anything with a school's colors on it, and keep the receipts; the eligibility review asks about teams, events, expenses, awards and anyone who marketed her.

THE FREE THINGS, IN THE ORDER THEY PAY OFF

1. Her own email, written by her, with a link that needs no login. Free, and it is the only thing a coach is required to read.
2. A free profile on the platform staffs use at tournaments, so a coach can find her schedule and her grades without asking.
3. The school's own recruit questionnaire. The two programs this book checked each post one, and it puts her on a list a staff actually maintains.
4. The free Eligibility Center profile page, which she can upgrade later.
5. A parent with a tripod, high and wide, at the end line, and a folder for every email a coach sends back.

9. CHECKLIST BY GRADE

One row per year, in order. Cross items off. If a year slips, the fix is usually more schools and one more month, not more money.

YEAR	DO THIS
9TH GRADE DONE	Play, and keep every grade. Lift with a plan she can write down. Find out how tall she is now, barefoot, to the nearest half inch, with a parent writing it down, and when she last grew. Spend nothing on recruiting.
10TH GRADE THIS YEAR	Make the club team and ask which qualifiers it enters. Shoot the whole season from a high wide angle at the end line. Build the list of 40 to 60 schools across all five levels. Open the free Eligibility Center profile page. Measure standing reach and approach touch, with the device and the date written down. Get a free profile on the platform staffs use at tournaments, with her unweighted Grade Point Average on a 4.0 scale. At the February region qualifier, learn what the staffs in the stands watch. In June 2027, after the contact date, send the first real round of emails.
11TH GRADE	Four approved core courses, and a counselor who checks each one against the NCAA list; a 2.3 core Grade Point Average is the Division I floor and 2.2 is the Division II floor. Register for certification before spring. Counselor uploads the transcript after four semesters, in June. Ask for a bid to the summer Junior Nationals. Go to one camp, at a school that answered her. Send grades in the fall, and the schedule before every tournament. From 1 August she may take Division I visits; ask for one inside that window.
12TH GRADE, BEFORE SEP 1	Send one update with new film, new numbers and the written offer question: how much, covering what, and renewed how. Make sure a full match sits behind the reel. Get re-measured: she may be an inch or two taller than the film says.
12TH GRADE, SEP TO NOV	Play. Send the schedule to every coach on the list, and the results after. From 1 August a school may give her a written offer of aid and the settlement benefits. On the second Wednesday in November, PROJECTED 8 November 2028, she may sign one. Ask about the dead period that week so nobody calls at the wrong time.
12TH GRADE, DECEMBER	Settle every question before she signs, then sign if the paper is right. The signing period stays open after the first date, on each school's own policy, so she is not forced into a November decision. If the paper is not right, do not sign to feel settled.
AFTER SIGNING	Do not let the final semester fall: finish all 16 approved subjects and graduate, or the paper can come apart. Counselor uploads the graduation transcript. Ask for the final athletics certification from 1 April 2029. If she wants to talk to another school after signing, get the release in writing first.

THE THREE THINGS THAT ACTUALLY MOVE A VOLLEYBALL RECRUIT

In this order: a schedule that puts her in front of staffs from January to June, a reel that opens with her best live-play clip and shows serve receive and defense, and a short email that reports real numbers with the method and the date on them. Everything on the paid list in Chapter 8 sits behind those three.

10. TEN WAYS FAMILIES GET VOLLEYBALL WRONG

1. **They plan the year around high school ball.** The state season is August to November, and college coaches are playing their own season then. 94 percent of college players came through club as well, by the NCAA's own study.
2. **They wait for a coach to write first.** A Division I or II coach may not answer her until 15 June 2027. She may write today, and USA Volleyball prints "NO RESTRICTIONS" on her side of it.
3. **They count 12 scholarships.** At a school that opted in, the number is an 18-player roster and aid may be any size on any of them. Sites that say women's volleyball was a 4.5 sport have copied the men's line.
4. **They pay $2,000 for a service and stop emailing.** Not one coach in this research said on the record that a paid tier moved a volleyball recruit, and there are 2026 complaints on file about refunds. The association's own guidance is to send more email, not less.
5. **They take a camp invite as interest.** USA Volleyball and the Junior Volleyball Association both say an invite may mean nothing, and every camp page checked says the camp is open to any entrant.
6. **They print a bare height and a bare vertical.** No college publishes a jump standard, one service's chart has a row labeled weight that holds heights, and a wearable reads about two inches higher than a Vertec for the same girl. An unlabelled number tells a coach the family does not know the sport.
7. **They send a nine-minute reel of drills.** Coaches say they watch 10 to 25 seconds and that match play beats practice clips. The first clip does the work.
8. **They skip Division III and the NAIA.** Division III alone is 417 teams with no athletic aid and full rosters, and the two Division III programs counted in Chapter 2 carry 19 and 25 players. Families who chase only a scholarship leave the biggest door shut.
9. **They sign a junior-college letter to hold a place.** It binds a school year, two of them cost a year, and a junior-college year now starts the NCAA's five-year clock, so one year there leaves four.
10. **They plan the money backwards.** The club fee is fixed, and travel is the line that surprises people. Budget four trips, ask what the fee excludes, and skip the packages.

11. SOURCES, AND WHAT WE COULD NOT SETTLE

Every rule, number and date here came from one of the documents below, read on 11 November 2026. Where two official pages disagree, both figures are printed, in the chapter that uses them.

2026-27 NCAA Division I Bylaws, for the five-year eligibility period at Bylaw 12.6 (revised 24 June 2026, effective 1 August 2026) and the recruiting sections at Bylaw 13.17. The roster-limit table came with the same adoption. web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008

2026-27 Division I women's volleyball recruiting calendar, for the contact period of 1 September to 30 November and the dead period of 9 to 12 November 2026. ncaaorg.s3.amazonaws.com/compliance/recruiting/calendar/2026-27/2026-27D1Rec_WVBRecruitingCalendar.pdf

NCAA signing dates for 2026-27, published 28 July 2026: "All Other Division I and II Sports, initial signing date November 11, 2026," with the final date set by each school. athleticsaid.s3.amazonaws.com/2026-27DI_SigningDates.pdf

NCAA news, 23 June 2025, adopting the roster limits; the Division I governance question-and-answer of February 2026, which says a school that does not opt in is not required to carry a roster limit; and a university's own settlement question-and-answer from June 2025 for the $20.5 million sharing figure and for the rule that the limit counts every player on a submitted roster.

NCAA news releases of June 2026 and August 2026 on the age-based eligibility model, and the Eligibility Center's own page on the Division I and Division II age-based rules, for the clock, the "not five for everyone" wording and the end of redshirts.

Division I Council report of 8 to 9 October 2024 ending the National Letter of Intent, the matching Division II action the same month, and the NCAA scholarships page that still says Division II "may still use" it.

Guide for the College-Bound Student-Athlete, 2026-27 edition, for the three account types, the 16 approved subjects, the 10-and-7 rule, the 2.3 and 2.2 floors, the end of the SAT and ACT requirement, the nonbinding celebratory form in Division III, and the insurance pages. The live registration page carries the fee she will actually pay.

NCAA core guarantees page, for the rule that first-year aid cannot be cut for athletics reasons, the written notice and appeal, and the two years of continued medical care; the 2025 news release for the line that a scholarship cannot be revoked unless the athlete chooses to transfer.

NCAA membership and sport sponsorship, projected 2026-27, data final 29 July 2026, for 348, 288 and 417 teams, 1,053 in all, and for the men's counts of 31, 41 and 141.

NCAA Research, estimated probability of competing in college athletics, and the 2023-24 participation counts, for 19,810 volleyball players. The National Federation of State High School Associations participation survey for 2024-25, for 492,799 high school players. The coaches' association's own odds page, counting 2019, for 4.6 percent and 0.6 percent.

NCAA Research, high school and club participation by sport, 2025, for 94 percent, 3 percent and 2 percent. USA Volleyball repeats the finding as "more than 90%" on its club-tournaments page.

USA Volleyball, national governing body: the college recruitment timeline for the 15 June contact date, the August and January visit dates, the five official visits and the note that a recruit has no restrictions; the recruiting question-and-answer for the camp-invite rule, the definition of real activity and the 5'7" libero figure; and the "am I too short" page.

One state association's girls volleyball schedule, used here as an example of a calendar and nothing more: the Wisconsin Interscholastic Athletic Association's 2026 season, from 17 August, with the final rounds 5 to 7 November in a rented arena. Her own association prints its own dates, classes and site.

One USA Volleyball region, the Badger Region, used as a worked example of what a region publishes: its qualifier page for 27 to 28 February 2027, the four bids on offer for 16s and the reallocation dates; two newsletters, December 2025 and May 2026, for 18,137 members and 148 clubs and for 14,628 youth girls; and the summer camp page that says its listings are paid advertisements.

AVCA, the coaches' association: the Phenom program page for the dates, the $259 fee and the field of about 400; the recruiting-calendar blog by a Texas State assistant coach for the 150 club tournaments; the camp-rules blog of April 2022 by a Kennesaw State assistant coach; the July 2026 blog by a Montana associate head coach for "how you move."

Junior Volleyball Association, "The Video Recruiting Process," for the don't list, the login rule and the camp brochure warning.

Coach statements on the record: John Cook, Nebraska, in a coaching blog; Mick Haley, Russ Rose and Jim Giacomazzi in a coaching magazine article; Kelly Sheffield at Big Ten Media Days, August 2026, and in August 2025; Kurt Vlasich of Claremont-Mudd-Scripps in a 2018 high school sports column; Julie Jenkins of Trinity, Jon Ellmann of UW-Oshkosh and Don Perkins of Kean in a Division III coaches' column of March 2025; Amie Held and Tori Plugge in association blogs. A former Division I head coach's own blog, 2008 and 2017, for the "club is 99%" line and the camp advice.

Eleven college roster pages, read 11 November 2026, for every height in Chapter 6 and the roster counts in Chapter 2: Wisconsin, Nebraska, Minnesota, Marquette, Milwaukee, UW-Green Bay, UW-Parkside, UW-La Crosse, UW-Whitewater, Viterbo and Grand View. That is one region's sample, not a shortlist: the point is the method, and a family can repeat it on its own list. Two hundred twelve listed heights were counted, and the medians are this book's own arithmetic. The twelfth page, counted at 22, was a public university in the same area.

NCAA national individual leader lists for kills, hitting percentage, assists, digs and aces, through games of 10 November 2026, taken

through the association's public data feed, for every cut line in Chapter 6 and for the libero-height count of 147 players. The top-100 position counts are this book's own count of those pages.

Size targets in Chapter 6 come from three recruiting services' positional guidelines and one club's posted tier chart, all printed as what they are. None is a rule. No college in this research publishes a jump standard.

Two studies of jump measurement, one of them on 128 Brazilian under-18 national players, for the gap of about two inches between a wearable device and a Vertec. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/29158616

Growth: the American Academy of Pediatrics, KidsHealth, Johns Hopkins, Merck's professional manual, Duke Health and a sports-medicine hospital, for the one-to-two-inch range after the first period and final height around 14 or 15; a journal study of 793 Swedish women and a second of 534 Latino girls for the range and the tail.

Club prices, all published by the clubs for 2026-27: Milwaukee Sting, Ignite, Colorado Boom, 513 Volleyball, Minnesota Select, Team Illinois, Revolution Jr, an Iowa club's tier sheet, NYC Juniors and Arizona Saguaros. Tryout fees, uniform costs and per-event travel billing come from the same pages.

Camp prices from the schools: Marquette's three camp pages, UW-Eau Claire, UW-Whitewater, UW-Oshkosh, Wisconsin Lutheran, UW-Stevens Point and a campus camp run by a camp company at UW-Madison. Event prices from the AVCA, Premier Academy, NIKE Winterfest, the Hawaii Showcase and the Sunshine and West Coast qualifier entry pages.

Service prices and complaints: two 2023 and 2025 reports on the market leader's tiers, a 2026 batch of Better Business Bureau complaints about refunds, three cheaper tools that publish their own prices, two video-editing marketplaces and one volleyball-specific shop, and the platform fee pages.

Email and reply-rate data: one tool company's 2026 email measurements, one soccer relationship-management company's study of 3,782 emails to 1,057 coaches, and a golf coach's survey of 42.6 emails a week. Every one is vendor data with a sales incentive, and none is volleyball-specific.

Name-and-image-of-likeness: a 2026 industry report for the $663 average volleyball deal and the comparison sports; its 2024 edition for the $5,868 expected annual value and the 2.9 percent and 0.8 percent dollar shares; and the NCAA's own NIL database for 2023-24, reported through a national outlet, for the 15.2 percent Power Four share and the $7,947 average. The state association's policy and the NCAA's $600 reporting rule close Chapter 8.

Men's volleyball: the association's own program counts, the National Club Volleyball Federation's 616 teams at 424 schools, and the university's own club history for the 2023 and 2025 club titles.

WHAT WE COULD NOT SETTLE

- **Which Division I schools opted in.** There is no published list. Ask each school, in the same email as the aid question.
- **Her own signing date, and the dead period around it.** The 2028-29 sheet does not exist yet. Both dates in Chapter 3 marked PROJECTED are arithmetic from the second-Wednesday rule and the Monday-to-Thursday rule, and either can move.
- **The camp conversation rule.** The association's 2022 statement that a Division I camp may only run between Memorial Day and 31 July, with no recruiting talk before 1 August of junior year, was not re-checked against the 2026-27 book. Ask the camp director.
- **What the fee actually is.** The live sign-up page says $120, the association's own printed guide says $110, and an athletics-only account is $75. Which account she needs depends on where she lands.
- **Division II paper.** One NCAA page says the old letter is gone, another says Division II may still use it. Ask the school.
- **How many teams and how many seats below Division I.** One service counts 226 NAIA schools; junior college counts in circulation run from about 300 to 545, and the association's own limits table sits behind a login.
- **Travel, for one region.** No club this book checked has published what two travel weekends cost a family. The only marker found was a big-city club's $670 to $830 a trip, used as a ceiling in Chapter 8.
- **Nothing official sets a size or a jump.** No association and no college publishes an approach or block standard by position. Every target in Chapter 6 is one company's hope, printed as one.
- **No volleyball reply-rate study exists.** The email numbers in Chapter 6 come from other sports, from companies that sell the tool, and show correlation, not cause.
- **"Letter of assurance."** No definition in any NCAA, NAIA or NJCAA material this book read. Treat it as talk.
- **How much taller she will be.** The sources give a range and a long tail, not a chart by birthday. A pediatrician with her growth chart can do better than any book.

Made by The Commit Book. Education, not legal advice. No result, no playing time, no acceptance, and no money is promised. Rule text, calendars, rosters and event pages checked 11 November 2026. The player, school, club and coaches in the sample email are invented.